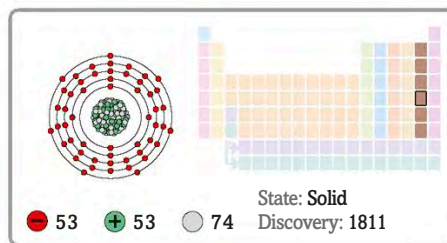


53

I

Iodine



Forms

Pure iodine in a glass sphere

This sealed glass container prevents iodine from reacting with air.

Purple iodine vapour

Purple-black solid iodine

Solid iodine **does not melt** when heated, but turns into a vapour.

Crab

This crab absorbs iodine from seawater.

Uses

Printing ink

These coloured inks are made using iodine compounds.

Polarizing sunglasses

These lenses contain iodine, which filters out bright, reflected light.

Candied cherries

The bright red colour of these cherries is due to an iodine dye.

This disinfectant is applied to wounds to stop the spread of infection.

Betadine



Iodine is the only halogen that is solid at room temperature. The element forms a purple gas when heated, and is named after the Greek word *iodes*, which means “violet”. Iodine was first discovered in seaweed, and many plants and animals in the sea have high levels of iodine.

Seafood, including **crabs** and fish, provide the element in our diet. The human body needs small amounts of iodine to make an important substance called thyroxine, which helps us grow. Iodine is also used to make **printing ink**, red and brown food dyes, and disinfectants.